

Paige Turner

Do not open before all ballots are collected.

Only the guest who memorized the announced murderer animal reads a confession. Everyone else keeps this envelope closed. If opened by mistake, stop before reading the next section aloud.

CONFESSION / Read only after identifying yourself

I was preparing an investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He threatened an injunction and exposure of a confidential museum source if I published. My reputation mattered, but protecting that source mattered more. He knew precisely where to apply pressure. During setup I borrowed the cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:45, I used the excuse of asking about my embargoed story to enter the salon. I dampened my gold-seamed linen with the sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim. That transferred the poison. I left with the cloth. The door entry, key loan and linen receipt were all real. What I left out was what I did between them.